

PSC 400, Political Theory

Syracuse University, Department of Political Science, Fall 2025

Tuesday and Thursday, 1:00 PM to 2:20 PM, Eggers Hall 010

Instructor: Professor R. Calderon. Office hours Wednesday 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM.

Description

A survey of major works in political theory from the classical period to the present, with attention to justice, authority, and the limits of the state. Reading is heavy and discussion is central.

Grading

Participation 15 percent, two short papers 40 percent, midterm 20 percent, final paper 25 percent.

Schedule

Week of	Topic	Reading
September 1, 2025	Justice and the city	Plato, selections
September 22, 2025	Authority and consent	Hobbes and Locke
October 13, 2025	Liberty	Mill
November 3, 2025	Justice as fairness	Rawls, selections
November 24, 2025	Critiques and replies	Course reader
December 1, 2025	Final paper workshop	Drafts due in class

Final paper due December 12, 2025 by 11:59 PM. Late work loses one third of a letter grade per day.